Darren: Skyblade Hunt - accepted local Candidate23

Decision: accept the bounded shoulder-color repair, then stop automated art edits.
Candidate22 remains the rollback. Publication is held. No Site changes were made.
This is an incremental repair; the creatures do not fully match the supplied art.

Diagnosis and repair
The pale shoulder blotches persisted in unlit albedo and disappeared in clay.
They were baked color contamination, not a reason to repeat skin-weight trials.
An object-space feathered mask corrects two existing color maps. The chest plates
and all decoded pixels outside the local mask/gutters are preserved exactly.
All 1,239 GLB accessors, 14 clips and every non-color buffer view are byte-identical.
The lossless PNG maps add 819,076 bytes (about 0.78 MiB); no FPS benefit is claimed.
Blender 5.2.2 LTS saved and reopened the editable source with exact packed images
and unchanged weights. The original Candidate22 source/export were not modified.

Verification of Candidate23
250 runtime/repair checks in fresh desktop and touch-emulated profiles passed.
Four deterministic ground/flight combat runs passed 16 checks; 132 captures saved.
Eight normal-frame keyboard/movement/pause/resume checks passed.
The 46-file release manifest is exact; only the SkyDrake GLB changed vs Candidate22.
This is not a physical-controller/phone test, full playthrough or GPU benchmark.
Candidate22's larger recovery/soak/deformation suite remains baseline evidence;
it was not rerun or counted as fresh Candidate23 coverage.

Concrete authored-art handoff
SkyDrake: white eye globes protrude beyond the lids; muzzle/eyelid contours remain rounder and less angular than the turnaround. Membranes are thin planar panels, and the tail is straighter/more horizontal. Elbow/hip compression and the soft shoulder material transition remain. Fixing those requires deliberate surface and joint-loop edits plus a consistent color/normal bake, followed by pose review. The full-resolution Candidate22 A/B/C experiments are rejected; do not promote them or repeat broad weight diffusion. Use accepted full-resolution SkyDrake15.
Chomp19: broad muzzle/forehead, wrinkles and tooth spacing remain approximate.
Stormbelly20: eye expression, lower jaw/lip and surface grooves remain approximate.

Blender is installed and sufficient for all of that work; no missing tool or missing reference blocks it. The remaining constraint is authored shape quality and validation, not approval. No new character design decision is needed: the supplied turnarounds remain the target. Recommended next separate art session: manually reshape SkyDrake's eye sockets/lids and muzzle against front/side views, accept those silhouettes early, then address joint topology and rebake. Preserve the rig/clip contract and retest all 14 clips before replacing the playable asset. Do not combine that larger sculpt with another blind weight/texture sweep.

Editable sources, relative to skyblade-current
art/overhaul/skydrake23/source/skydrake-lod.blend (accepted reduced texture repair)
art/overhaul/skydrake15/source/skydrake-candidate.blend (accepted full-resolution)
art/overhaul/chomp19/source/chomprex-candidate.blend and chomprex-lod.blend
art/overhaul/stormbelly20/source/heavyweight-candidate.blend and heavyweight-lod.blend
art/references/ (original supplied turnarounds; present, not invented)
art/overhaul/skydrake23/review/SkyDrake23-before-after.png (current repair)
art/overhaul/skydrake22/review/boards/SkyDrake22-reference-comparison.png
(unchanged silhouette defects; its shoulder color predates Candidate23)

Local play: extract this ZIP into a new folder, run node serve.cjs with Node.js installed, then open http://127.0.0.1:4330/ in a separate browser profile for saves. The server binds only locally; stop with Ctrl+C. Do not open index.html directly.
Existing live URL: https://darren-skyblade-reach.gosplekaiju.chatgpt.site
Exact project: appgprj_6acf0e7886908191820064ec6fa5afa0. No publication in this pass.

SKYDRAKE23 / SHOULDER COLOR REPAIR

Candidate22 before / Candidate23 after. Matched poses, camera and lighting.

CANDIDATE22

CANDIDATE23

Idle shoulder close-up





Opposite side during attack





Existing gameplay; controlled ground attack fixture

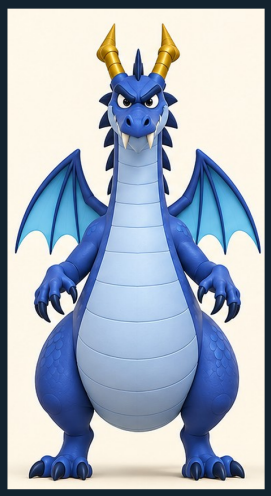
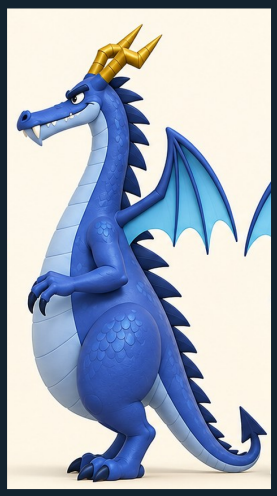




No mesh, normal map, rig, animation, gameplay or save changes. Shoulder softness remains.

SKYDRAKE22 / REFERENCE AND PRESERVED SILHOUETTE

Supplied illustration uses a different pose/projection. Only skin weights changed in this pass.

SUPPLIED TURNAROUND	CANDIDATE21	CANDIDATE22
		
FRONT		
		
SIDE		

Remaining likeness gaps: protruding eye whites, eyelid/muzzle shape, thin wing membranes, tail profile and surface detail.

These require a deliberate sculpt/retopology and texture-bake pass; further weight diffusion will not repair them.